Self-Assessment: Self-Advocacy for Job-Seeking Parents

This self-assessment helps you evaluate your ability to advocate for yourself, your child, your health, and your mental well-being while balancing job seeking and parenting. Answer each question honestly using the following scale:

☐ **Always** (3 points) ☐ **Sometimes** (2 points) ☐ **Rarely/Never** (1 point)

INSTRUCTIONS:

- Read each statement and mark the score that best describes you.
- At the end of each section, total your points in the 'Section Score' box.
- Add up all section scores to get your final score.

Understanding Yourself & Your Needs

Question	Always (3)	Sometimes (2)	Rarely/Never (1)
I know my strengths and what I am good at.	☐	☐	☐
I can clearly explain the type of job I want.	☐	☐	☐
I understand the challenges I may face.	☐	☐	☐
I am aware of my rights as a worker.	☐	☐	☐
I take care of my mental and physical health during my job search.	☐	☐	☐

Section Score: _____ **/ 15**

Job Search & Employment Readiness

Question	Always (3)	Sometimes (2)	Rarely/Never (1)
I have a strong resume.	☐	☐	☐
I know how to search for jobs.	☐	☐	☐
I practice answering interview questions.	☐	☐	☐
I can explain job gaps confidently.	☐	☐	☐
I am comfortable negotiating salary and benefits.	☐	☐	☐

Section Score: _____ **/ 15**

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Balancing Work & Family

Question	Always (3)	Sometimes (2)	Rarely/Never (1)
I look for jobs that fit my family's needs.	☐	☐	☐
I have a childcare plan for when I start working.	☐	☐	☐
I know my rights for family leave.	☐	☐	☐
I set clear work-home boundaries.	☐	☐	☐
I have a backup plan for family emergencies.	☐	☐	☐

Section Score: _____ **/ 15**

Making Decisions & Problem-Solving

Question	Always (3)	Sometimes (2)	Rarely/Never (1)
I make informed decisions that benefit both my career and family.	☐	☐	☐
I know where to get help when I face job search challenges.	☐	☐	☐
I feel confident negotiating my work schedule, salary, or job duties.	☐	☐	☐
I adjust my job search strategy when needed.	☐	☐	☐
I feel comfortable making difficult decisions under pressure.	☐	☐	☐

Section Score: _____ **/ 15**

Building a Support System

Question	Always (3)	Sometimes (2)	Rarely/Never (1)
I have a network of friends, family, or mentors who support me.	☐	☐	☐
I connect with job support groups, online communities, or career programs.	☐	☐	☐
I reach out to former colleagues, bosses, or contacts for job leads.	☐	☐	☐
I attend job fairs, networking events, or workshops when possible.	☐	☐	☐
I ask for help when I need it, whether for job searching or family support.	☐	☐	☐

Section Score: _____ **/ 15**

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Understanding My Rights & Finances

Question	Always (3)	Sometimes (2)	Rarely/Never (1)
I know my rights regarding workplace discrimination and fair pay.	☐	☐	☐
I have a financial plan while looking for a job.	☐	☐	☐
I know about resources that provide childcare, food, or housing assistance.	☐	☐	☐
I understand the benefits of different jobs.	☐	☐	☐
I know how to report unfair treatment at work.	☐	☐	☐

Section Score: _____ **/ 15**

Advocating for My Child

Question	Always (3)	Sometimes (2)	Rarely/Never (1)
I know my child's needs at home, school, and in the community.	☐	☐	☐
I can speak up for my child's education, health, and safety.	☐	☐	☐
I know my rights as a parent in my child's school.	☐	☐	☐
I make sure my child has access to the resources they need.	☐	☐	☐
I talk with teachers, doctors, and community members to support my child's success.	☐	☐	☐
I teach my child how to speak up for themselves in school and social settings.	☐	☐	☐
I help my child understand and express their feelings and needs.	☐	☐	☐
I look for programs or services that support working parents and children.	☐	☐	☐
I feel confident making decisions about my child's care and education.	☐	☐	☐
I make time to listen to my child's concerns and help them solve problems.	☐	☐	☐

Section Score: _____ **/ 30**

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Advocating for Health Needs

Question	Always (3)	Sometimes (2)	Rarely/Never (1)
I make my health a priority and take care of my physical and mental well-being.	☐	☐	☐
I speak up to doctors and healthcare providers when I have questions or concerns.	☐	☐	☐
I know my rights when it comes to healthcare access and workplace accommodations.	☐	☐	☐
I make sure my child receives the medical care they need.	☐	☐	☐
I seek out low-cost or free healthcare options if needed.	☐	☐	☐
I ask for workplace accommodations if I have a health condition that affects my job.	☐	☐	☐
I teach my child how to speak up about their own health needs.	☐	☐	☐
I keep track of important health documents for myself and my child.	☐	☐	☐
I know where to find resources for mental health support.	☐	☐	☐
I encourage healthy habits for myself and my family.	☐	☐	☐

Section Score: _____ **/ 30**

Advocating for Mental Health

Question	Always (3)	Sometimes (2)	Rarely/Never (1)
I acknowledge when I am feeling stressed, overwhelmed, or anxious.	☐	☐	☐
I seek professional help when needed.	☐	☐	☐
I make time for self-care and stress management activities.	☐	☐	☐
I set boundaries to protect my emotional and mental well-being.	☐	☐	☐
I talk openly with my child about mental health and emotions.	☐	☐	☐
I encourage my child to express their feelings and seek help when needed.	☐	☐	☐
I educate myself on mental health resources available to me and my family.	☐	☐	☐
I know my rights regarding mental health accommodations at work.	☐	☐	☐
I practice positive coping skills to manage anxiety and stress.	☐	☐	☐
I support my child's mental health by creating a safe and supportive home environment.	☐	☐	☐

Section Score: _____ **/ 30**

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Final Score Calculation

Section	Total Points Possible	Your Score
Understanding Yourself & Your Needs	15	
Job Search & Employment Readiness	15	
Balancing Work & Family	15	
Making Decisions & Problem-Solving	15	
Building a Support System	15	
Understanding My Rights & Finances	15	
Advocating for My Child	30	
Advocating for Health Needs	30	
Advocating for Mental Health	30	
TOTAL SCORE	**180**	

Notes: _____

Scoring Guide

150-180 points – Strong Advocate
You are confident in advocating for yourself, your child, your health, and your mental well-being while balancing job seeking and parenting.

100-149 points – Growing Advocate
You have some good self-advocacy skills but may need to strengthen certain areas.

60-99 points – Needs Improvement
You may struggle with self-advocacy in one or more areas. Consider seeking support and training.

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